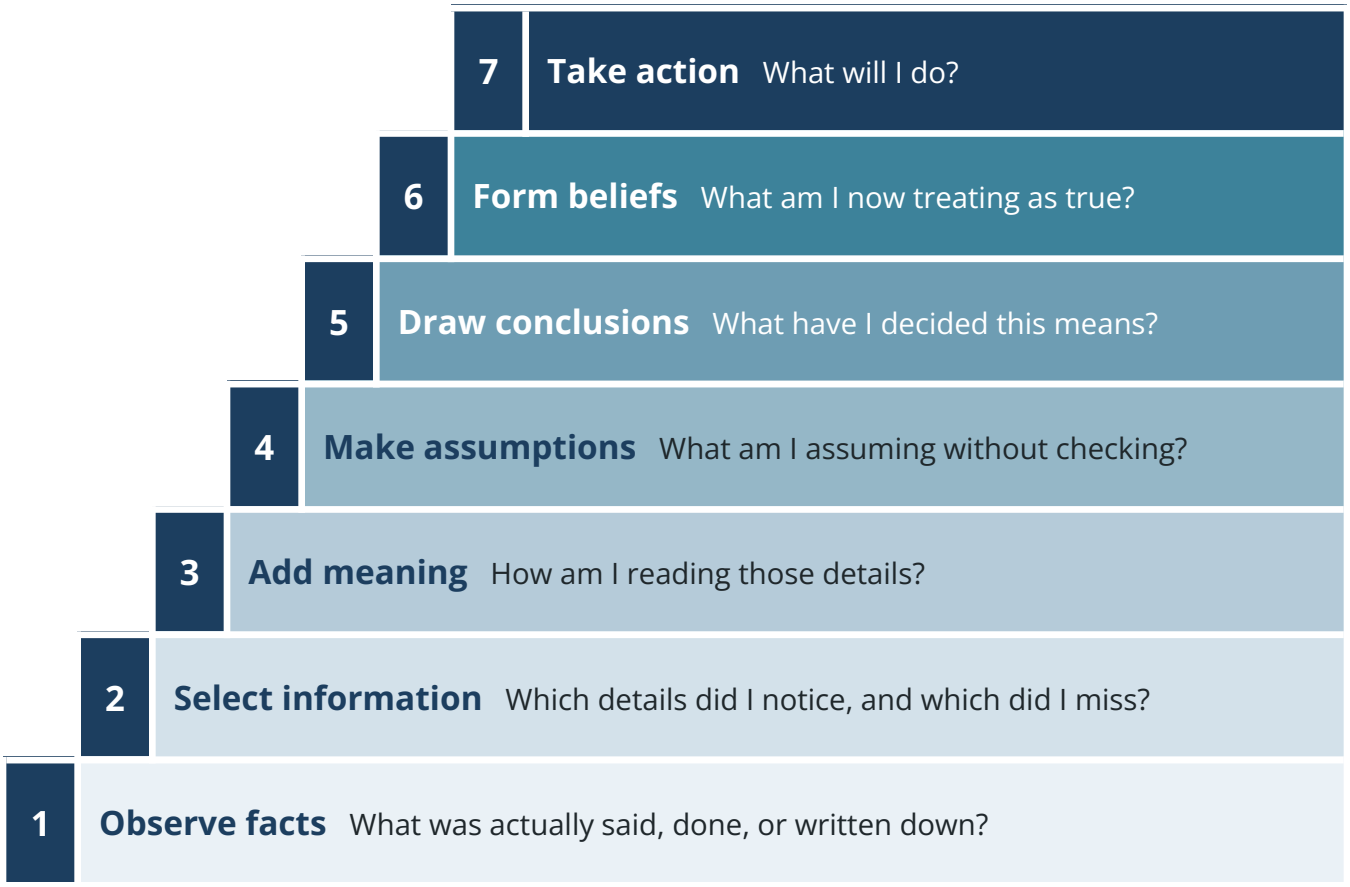
02 | LADDER OF INFERENCE | FLYER

The Ladder of Inference

Check your facts before you act

People often jump from what they see to a conclusion in seconds. The ladder shows the steps in between, so you can tell when you are treating an assumption as a fact.



START HERE • Read from 1 at the bottom to 7 at the top.

How to use it

Work back down the ladder. What do I actually know? What have I added? What question would test my assumption? Get the answer before you decide or escalate.

Our beliefs also shape what we notice next. This is called the feedback loop.

Source: Decision & Escalation training, Supervisor edition, slides 8–9. Model: Trevor Maber, TED-Ed, "Rethinking thinking."